



- The **suffix -y acts as a vowel**, so, if adding it to words ending in a silent -e, drop the silent -e. For example, *ice* becomes *icy* and *spice* becomes *spicy*.

## GLOSSARY

**Prefix** A group of letters attached to the start of a word that can change the root word's meaning.

**Root** The smallest part of a word without a prefix or suffix attached.

**Suffix** A group of letters attached to the end of a word that can change the root word's meaning.

**Syllable** A unit of pronunciation that has one vowel sound.

## Words ending in -y

Words that end in -y can also change spelling when a suffix is added. The main factor that determines this spelling change is whether the final -y is preceded by a consonant or a vowel.

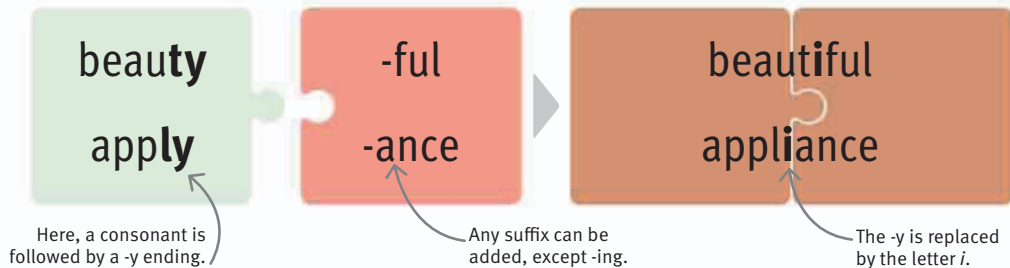
### ▷ Exceptions

Like words ending in -e, there are exceptions to the rules for words ending in -y.

| Root word | Suffix | New word |
|-----------|--------|----------|
| day       | -ly    | daily    |
| dry       | -ness  | dryness  |
| shy       | -ly    | shyly    |
| shy       | -ness  | shyness  |
| sly       | -ly    | slyly    |
| sly       | -ness  | slyness  |

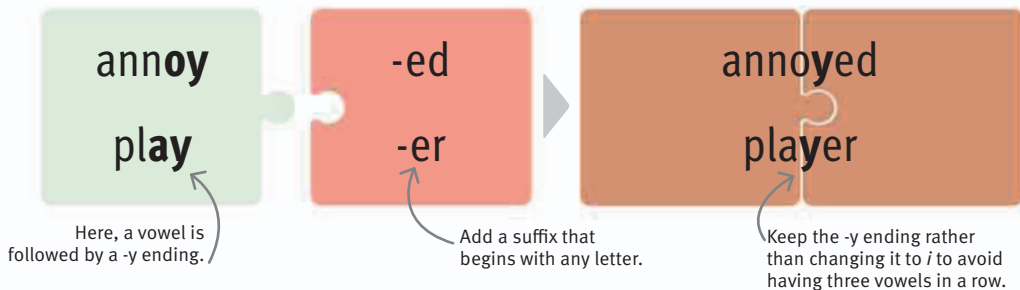
### ▷ Rule 1

If a word ends in a consonant and -y, the -y is replaced by *i* when any suffix except for -ing is added.



### ▷ Rule 2

If a word ends in a -y preceded by a vowel, the -y is kept when a suffix is added.



### ▷ Rule 3

If a word ends in a -y, the -y is kept when the suffix -ing is added.

